

Lawrence Chikapa Phuka

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Ntcheu, Malawi

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Practical ICT support professional with hands-on campus experience in network administration, lab operations, and user support. Skilled in pfSense network configuration, routine systems maintenance, and rapid troubleshooting. Focused on keeping learning platforms and computer labs reliable while training users to improve digital literacy.

CORE SKILLS

- **Network & Security:** pfSense configuration; firewall rules; DHCP; NAT; basic VPN setup; traffic shaping
- **IT Support:** Hardware setup; software troubleshooting; lab maintenance; Windows/macOS/Linux/Android administration
- **Web & Software:** HTML; CSS; JS; PHP; MYSQL; WordPress; Divi; lightweight educational software development and deployment
- **Operations:** Scheduled backups; routine security checks; SOP creation; documentation
- **Training & Communication:** Weekly drop-in sessions; user onboarding; quick-reference guides; workshop delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Malawi Adventist University, Lakeview Campus — IT Assistant

Jan 2026 – Present

- Configured and managed campus network using pfSense, implementing firewall rules, DHCP, NAT, and basic VPN access to improve security and remote connectivity.
- Provided frontline IT support, addressing multiple support requests each week and resolving hardware and software issues with same-day or next-day service.
- Performed routine lab maintenance and updates, conducting weekly checks and monthly system updates to maximize availability for teaching and exams.
- Managed the university website and digital learning tools, publishing course materials and troubleshooting access to support teaching continuity.

- Implemented scheduled backups and periodic security reviews, improving recovery readiness and reducing data-loss risk.
- Delivered weekly drop-in support sessions and short workshops, increasing user confidence and reducing repeat support needs.
- Authored concise IT documentation and quick-reference guides, streamlining onboarding and first-line troubleshooting.

Learn360 and Educational Software Projects — Founder & Software Developer

2024 – Present · <https://learn360.free.nf/>

- Designed and launched Learn360, an accessible e-learning platform for beginner ICT students; developed additional lightweight tools for low-bandwidth contexts.
- Built responsive front ends, integrated quizzes and multimedia lessons, and handled deployment and basic maintenance.
- Led outreach and user testing to refine usability for rural learners.

Selected Projects

- **pfSense Campus Network:** Deployed pfSense as the primary gateway for lab networks; configured DHCP, firewall rules, NAT, and basic traffic shaping.
- **Learn360 Platform:** End-to-end development of an e-learning site with quizzes, video lessons, and low-bandwidth optimizations.
- **IT Documentation Pack:** Created quick guides for common lab issues, onboarding checklists, and backup procedures.

EDUCATION

Ntonda Community Technical College — Diploma, Information & Communication Technology (2024–2025)

Nsaruru Secondary School — Malawi School Certificate of Education (MSCE) (2018–2022)

Chitungo & Kabuthu Primary Schools — Primary School Leaving Certificate (PSLC) (2010–2018)

Certifications

Certificate in Video Production and Graphic Design — SANWECKAMC Tech-Companions (2023)

REFERENCES

- **McLean Z Maunjili — ICT Officer, Malawi Adventist University · Phone: +265 99 149 9173 · Email: maunjilim@mau.adventist.org**
- **Rasheed Kasito — SANWECKAMC Tech-Companions · Phone: +265 99 948 4949**

- **Mr. Elias Sande — Ntonda Technical College · Phone: +265 99 240 0615**